

India Emerging Consumer

India Quick Commerce: From the gold rush to the long harvest...



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Our [2026 Outlook](#) had forecast a volatile 2026 with high competitive intensity, which we have seen in 1H. We expect network density to increase in 2H26 but discounting intensity may moderate faster than investors expect.

100% QC industry growth is decisively over. India's QC industry NOV has skyrocketed to a ~\$14 Bn annualized NOV (4Q26). Our supply side, bottom-up, proprietary model suggests a \$35 Bn Profitable SAM for QC by F30. While the \$14 Bn QC NOV has an industry EBITDA of (-10-12%), Blinkit's \$6 Bn NOV is at break-even. We retain our 2026 forecast of ~80% NOV industry growth, which would decelerate further in 2027/ 2028. Future growth may need to come from wallet-share expansion and not customer acquisition, especially in top-50 cities.

E-comm and Q-comm lines are blurring. Blinkit sells 80K+ SKUs in NCR and 50K+ in next-7 Metros. Instamart also offers ~50K SKUs. Q-comm players have clearly encroached on E-comm territory. Q-comm is also deploying the festive playbook of E-comm to boost adoption. A part of future Q-comm growth could be channel shift away from EC - a prospect which may have contributed to Flipkart and Amazon increasing their QC efforts.

Network build-out is still accelerating, leading to an over-crowded market. QC players added ~900 dark stores in last 3-4 months. We estimate ~7,000 dark stores as of 1Q27 covering ~2,700 pincodes and ~250+ Mn consumers. **50%+ of new dark stores were added in Top-8 Metros with 44% of Metro pincodes now being served by all Top-5 QC players.** Flipkart and Amazon Now have led the build-out with ~500 stores added. Amazon is also available in ~35 cities vs. ~10 earlier. Blinkit has seen a shift in its expansion to Tier 2/3 cities, with 55% of new stores going there.

Same city. Same customer. Slightly different strategies. (a) Product - In metros, assortment of Top-3 is similar at ~50K SKUs in same sub-categories. Focus is to expand wallet share by promoting event-days (read Mother's Day, Valentine's Day etc.). (b) Pricing - Zepto, Amazon and Flipkart continue deep-discounting to acquire customers. Blinkit and Instamart are striving for better economics. (c) Dark Stores - Here is where the strategy differs today. Blinkit splits its non-grocery SKUs across multiple, near-by stores whereas Swiggy consolidates them into Megastores. Amazon and Flipkart may decide to go wide (lower stores/city). These divergent approaches suggest operators are optimizing for different combinations of market share, capital efficiency, and profitability.

Tough unit economics may force moderation of customer incentives earlier than expected. QC direct costs have a structural floor near INR95-100 / order, putting a cap on the scope for operating leverage. With the industry today losing ~\$2.5 Bn on an (annualized run rate), a strong balance sheet is a necessary (but not sufficient) condition of success. Improving unit economics requires better order monetization - and we are seeing efforts across the board. Blinkit has reduced discounts, Instamart is shedding low AOV order volumes, Zepto seems to have increased MOV to Rs 149 and has experimented with rain fees, Amazon's incentive structure has a sliding scale. We expect the discounting/ incentives led intensity to start moderating in 2H26, which is faster than our earlier expectations.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	15 Jul 2026		Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
		Cur	Closing Price			Cur	2026A	2027E	2028E	2026A	2027E	2028E
ETERNAL.IN (Eternal)	O	INR	294.80	350.00	(19.1)%	INR	0.40	1.92	3.59	737.0	153.7	82.2
SWIGGY.IN (Swiggy)	O	INR	270.09	430.00	(62.2)%	INR	(16.87)	(7.17)	(0.15)	(16.0)	(37.7)	N/M
ASIA			1,910.77									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

Blinkit remains the most comfortably placed on profitability metrics with the highest cash balance. We think the competitive threat perception will moderate in H2, as

- The pace of dark store additions slows down sequentially as the Top-30-40 cities become over saturated
- The customer incentives (product discounts, wallet cash backs etc.) become more rational

Any such moderation supports Blinkit's business case as the market leader and the most profitable player today.

We expect **Instamart** to achieve contribution break-even in 1Q27 with a sequential reduction in its Adj EBITDA loss. However, its path to EBITDA break-even is less imminent, depends on the competitive intensity & may be volatile. The key decision for Instamart going ahead is to balance between utilizing the incremental contribution margin money to fund growth (stores + incentives) or to bank it for improvement in EBITDA. The management's decision of this balance will be governed more by market dynamics than their own priorities.

We retain our Outperform ratings for Eternal (TP of INR 350) and Swiggy (TP of INR 430).

VALUATION COMPS TABLE

Links to other relevant reports:

- 8 Jul 2026 - [India Consumer: Macro data suggests caution in expecting a broad based recovery. \(7/x\)](#)
- 24 Jun 2026 - [Pre-IPO: Zepto - the B-I-Z of quick commerce ... stacking the Top-3 players on key metrics.](#)
- 29 May 2026 - [India Consumer: Putting up a brave face ... \(6/x\)](#)
- 8 May 2026 - [Swiggy Q4FY26: The Amazing Race or The Survivor ...](#)
- 30 Apr 2026 - [India Consumer: Artificial Intelligence - Sooner or Later - This will go two ways. First gradually, and maybe only then suddenly.](#)
- 29 Apr 2026 - [Eternal Q4FY26: The growth is lovely, dark, and deep; now we have margins to keep ...](#)
- 28 Apr 2026 - [Pre-IPO: Zepto - Building A New Retail Playbook for India.](#)
- 9 Apr 2026 - [India E-Commerce: It's getting really crowded in here ...](#)
- 23 Mar 2026 - [India E-Commerce: Non-grocery assortment is Eternal & Swiggy's path to Quick Commerce profitability](#)
- 25 Feb 2026 - [India E-Commerce: Agentic AI hype, meet on-ground reality.](#)
- 18 Feb 2026 - [Inside Quick Commerce: Key webinar takeaways - Tier2 is new battleground, operational excellence is key.](#)
- 16 Feb 2026 - [India E-Commerce: Decoding the great dark store land grab ...](#)
- 9 Jan 2026 - [India E-commerce: Outlook 2026 ... Brace for volatility.](#)

DETAILS

A WORD ON METHODOLOGY

As far as we can tell, our attempt towards a data-based-deep-dive to figure out the Quick Commerce competition landscape is the first in the industry. We are helped, significantly, by the Bernstein proprietary database of ~19,000 pincodes across ~3,000 cities covering the entire ~1,400 Mn population in India. Each pincode data point has the demographics and extent of retail presence there.

This database was instrumental in our ability to create a bottom-up estimation of the Quick Commerce SAM in our initiation report (LINK). When we combine this understanding with our database of the Quick Commerce store locations, we can draw meaningful insights in this report. The data is collected between the period July-1 2026 to July-10 2026.

Some notes about how to interpret the data and possible limitations:

- India population data (even at a country / city level and most certainly at a pincode level) is extrapolated from multiple signals given the lack of official census data for a long time.
- Our database has ~19,000 pincodes and covers all areas in India.
- Pincodes vary in sizes, materially. Some are as small as a few sqkm while some are few thousand sqkm. Some have 10 Million!
- When our database indicates that a pincode is serviceable by a dark store, we mean at least some part of the pincode is serviceable. It is not necessary that all the locations in that pincode would be serviceable.
- The data in this report was collected over the period from July 1' 2026 to July 10' 2026 and is being updated periodically.

All thoughts-suggestions-datapoints for improving this are very welcome. Having put our approach out there, we are confident in the analysis and their conclusions as they point to the state and possible evolution of the Quick Commerce industry.

THE 100% QC INDUSTRY GROWTH IS DECISIVELY OVER.

We estimate quick commerce industry ended FY26 at a ~\$14 Bn annualized NOV run-rate of which ~\$12 Bn came from Blinkit, Instamart and Zepto (B-I-Z) while the remaining ~\$2-2.5 Bn came from the other players (Amazon, Flipkart, Bigbasket). Quarterly NOV for B-I-Z has grown from ~\$1 Bn in 1Q25 to ~\$2.9 Bn in 4Q26. However, in INR terms the YoY growth peaked at ~116% and has slowed every quarter since then to reach 81% in 4Q26 ([Exhibit 1](#)). We do not expect the industry to see triple-digit growth again.

How big can this market get? Our supply-side model suggests that India can profitably support ~8,500 dark stores across ~3,800 pincodes ([Exhibit 2](#)). At ~2,000 orders per day per store (OPDPS) and an AOV of ~INR 550 this translates into a ~\$35 Bn profitable SAM by FY30 ([Exhibit 3](#)). The industry is already at ~40% of this number.

Profitability however remains poor. The industry makes a ~(-10-12%) EBITDA margin on \$14 Bn NOV while Blinkit is at break-even on its ~\$6 Bn NOV. This means the remaining ~\$8 Bn of industry NOV is losing money at a much deeper rate.

Hence, there are two ways of thinking about our SAM estimates -

- "From \$14 Bn to \$35 Bn, we are forecasting the industry to only become 2.5x, which is a 4-year CAGR of ~25%."
- "From \$6 Bn of Zero EBITDA NOV, we are forecasting the profitable part of the industry to be \$35 Bn, which is nearly 6x and a 4-year CAGR of ~55%. It is likely that in addition to this profitable part, considering investor appetite, the actual size of the industry may be much higher."

Among the Top-3 players Blinkit and Zepto have taken turns as the fastest growth player while Instamart trails both of them ([Exhibit 4](#)). We retain our 2026 forecast of ~80% industry NOV growth which should gradually slow in 2027 and 2028.

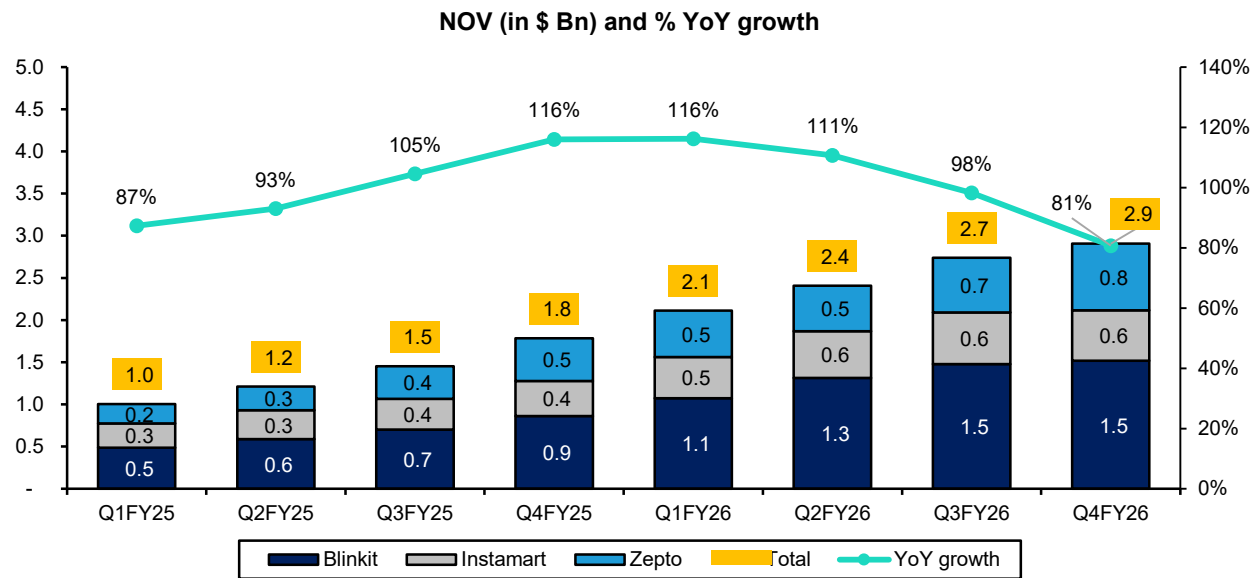
Where will future growth come from?

The MAU (Monthly Active User) growth profile across players has been flattening - including Blinkit and Instamart. Blinkit's MAU has grown to ~83 Mn and Instamart's standalone app is at ~20 Mn ([Exhibit 6](#)).

At an industry level, we expect the contribution to future growth may be from increasing wallet share of acquired customers (frequency x AOV). This could be driven by more categories per customer, thus creating incremental consumption patterns.

And most importantly, we expect this to be true in the Top-50 cities.

EXHIBIT 1: We estimate QC industry NOV run-rate as ~\$14 Bn (= ~\$ 12 Bn for Eternal + Zepto + Swiggy + ~2-2.5 Bn for Others).

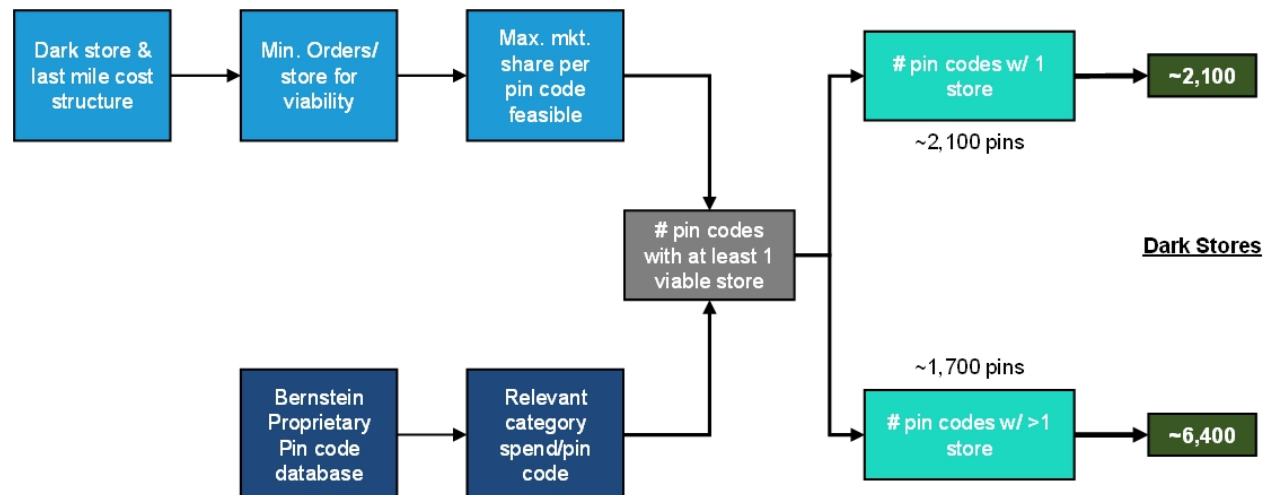


*Zepto NOV is calculated as Zepto NRV (Net Receivables Value) minus ad and subscription income to arrive at a like-to-like comparison with Blinkit and Instamart

** YoY growth %-age taken in INR terms

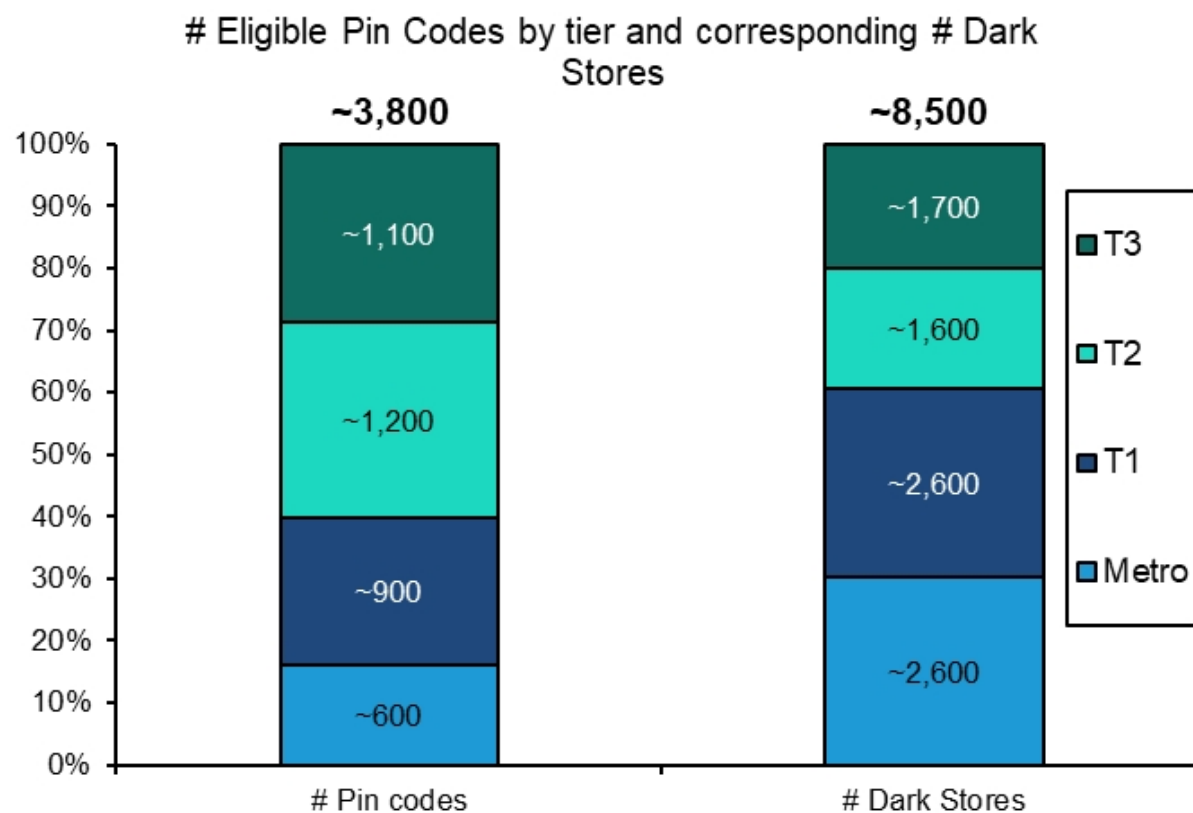
Source: Company reports, Zepto DRHP, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: Our methodology for QC SAM estimation using Supply Side economics of dark stores



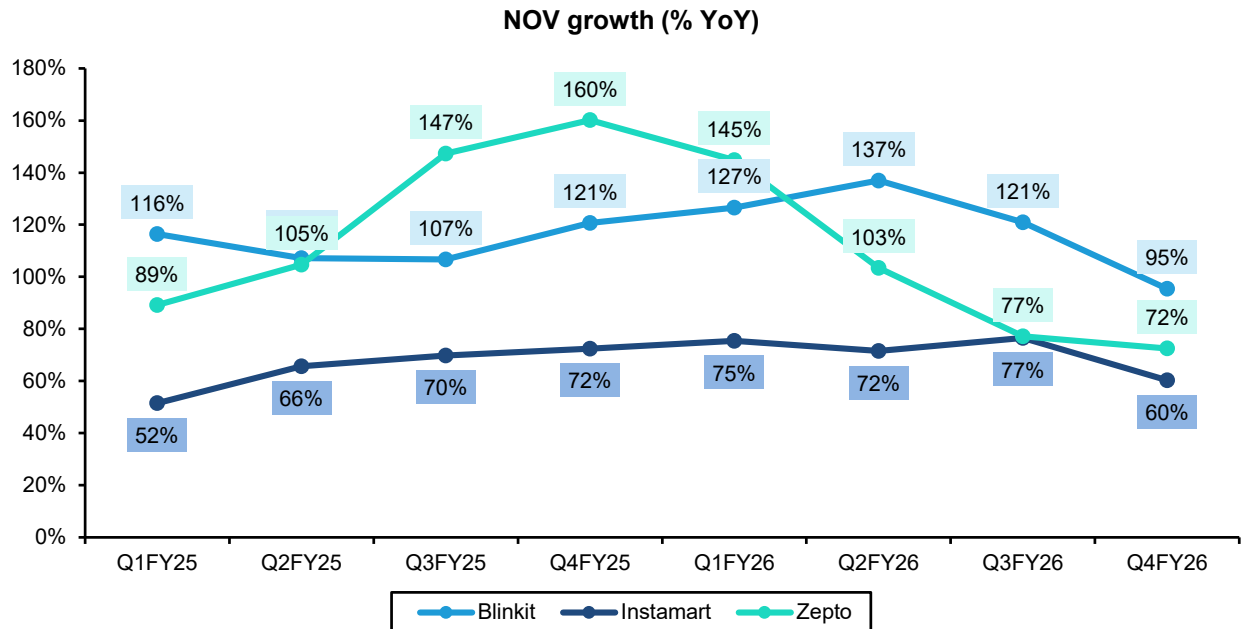
Source: Company websites, Bernstein store database, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 3: **Our supply side analysis gives us a potential for ~8.5k profitable dark stores in ~3.8k pincodes of India resulting in \$35 bn as profitable market size by F30.**

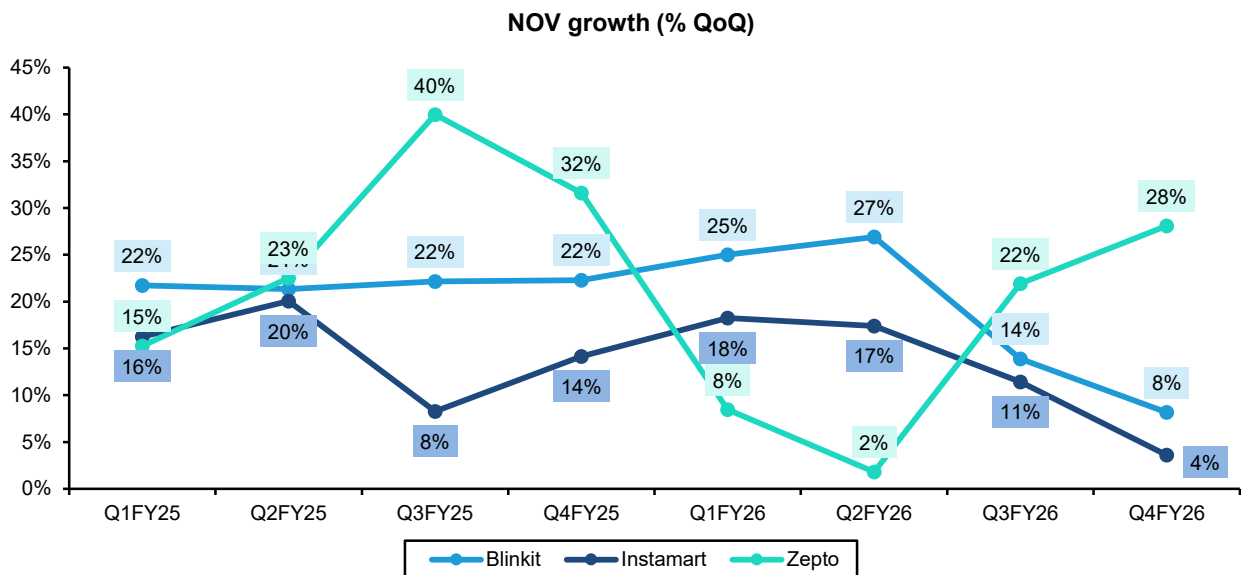


~8,500 dark stores	×	~2,000 orders/ day/ store	×	~INR 550 AOV	=	~\$ 35 Bn Profitable SAM
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Source: Company websites, Bernstein store database, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 4: **NOV growth trajectory has been reducing gradually across players**

Source: Company reports, Zepto DRHP, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 5: **QoQ growth has been volatile across players with Zepto clearly pulling ahead in the last 2 quarters**

Source: Company reports, Zepto DRHP, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 6: Zepto's MAU has stayed flat at ~59 Mn while Blinkit continues to climb, crossing 83 Mn. We expect new customer addition to be slower for the industry.

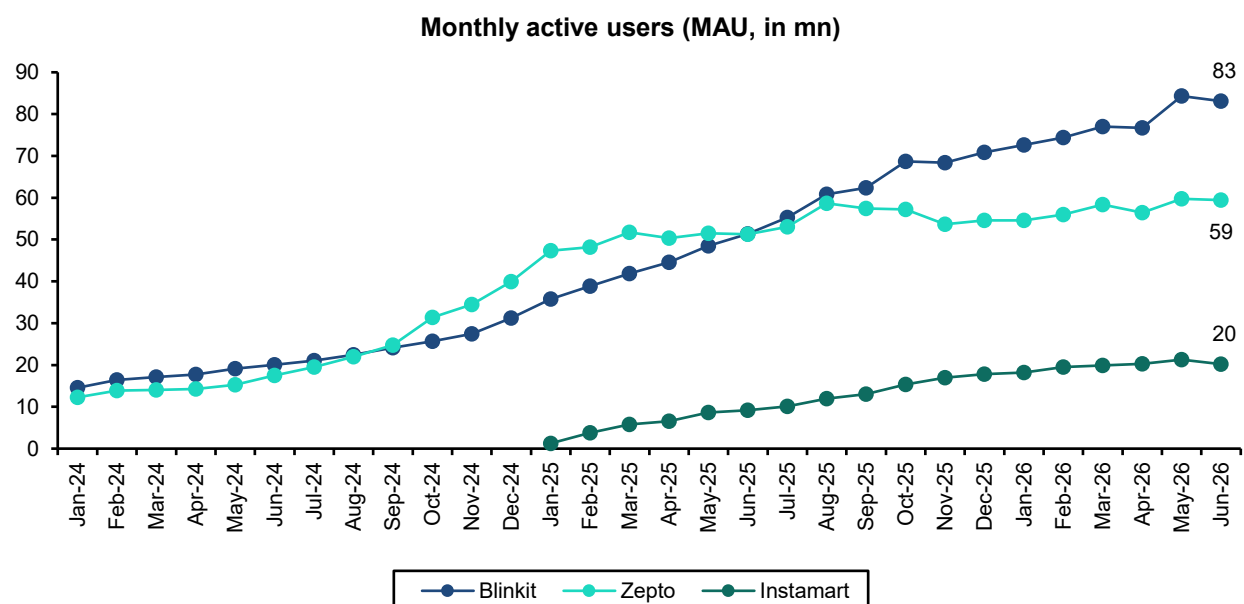
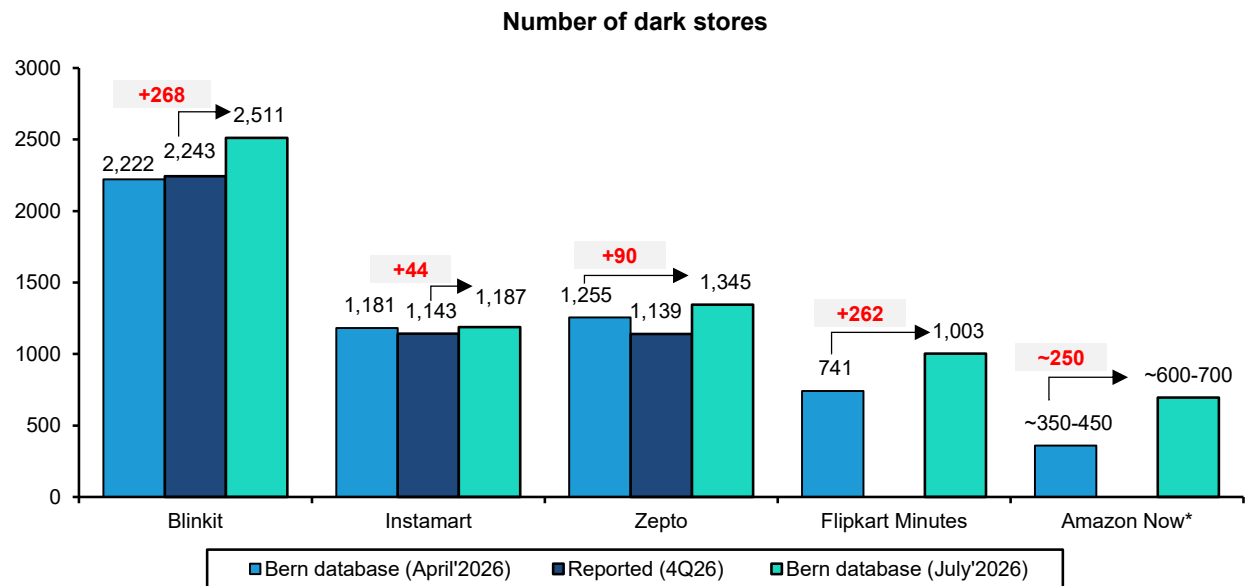
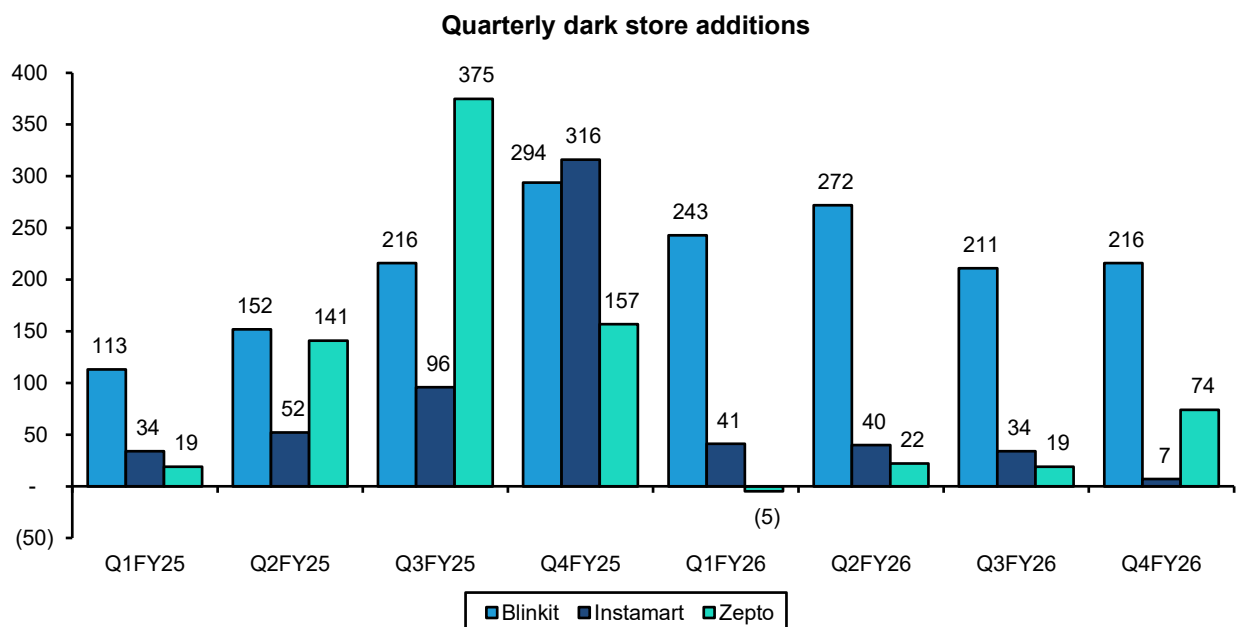


EXHIBIT 7: The five players together operate ~6,500 dark stores (and BigBasket has another ~800) with ~900 stores added in a single quarter as per Bernstein proprietary database



*For Amazon Now, we have estimated the range of number of dark stores using the ratio of darkstore per serviceable pincode for others
Source: Company, Bernstein store database & analysis

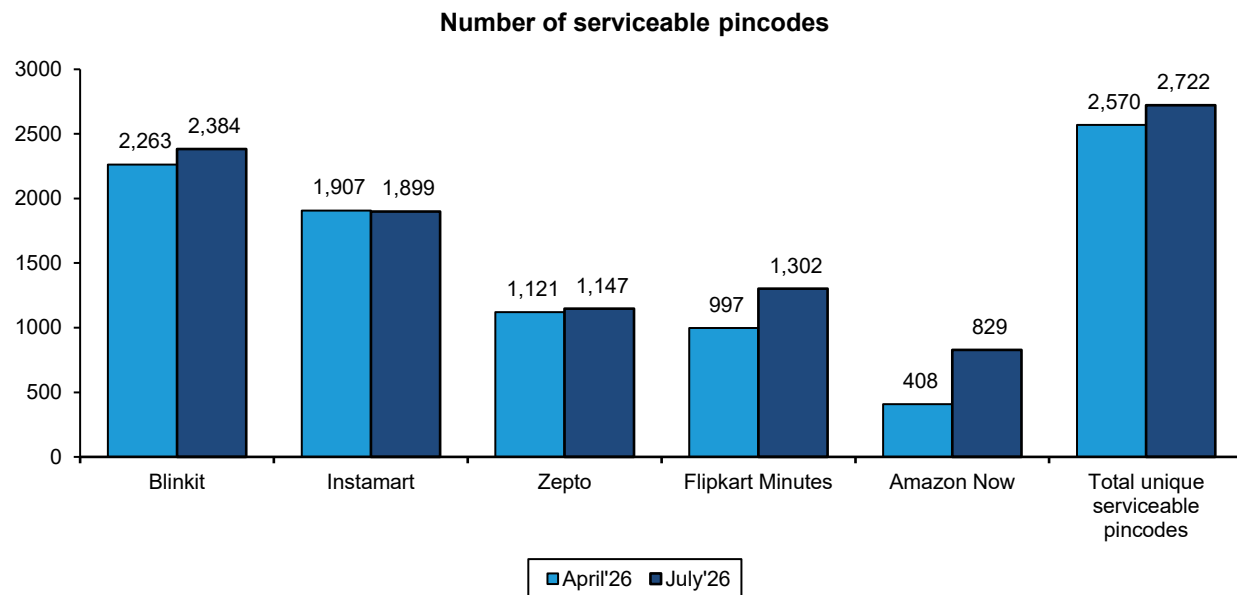
EXHIBIT 8: Blinkit has been the consistent expander of store network.



Source: Company reports, Zepto DRHP, Bernstein analysis

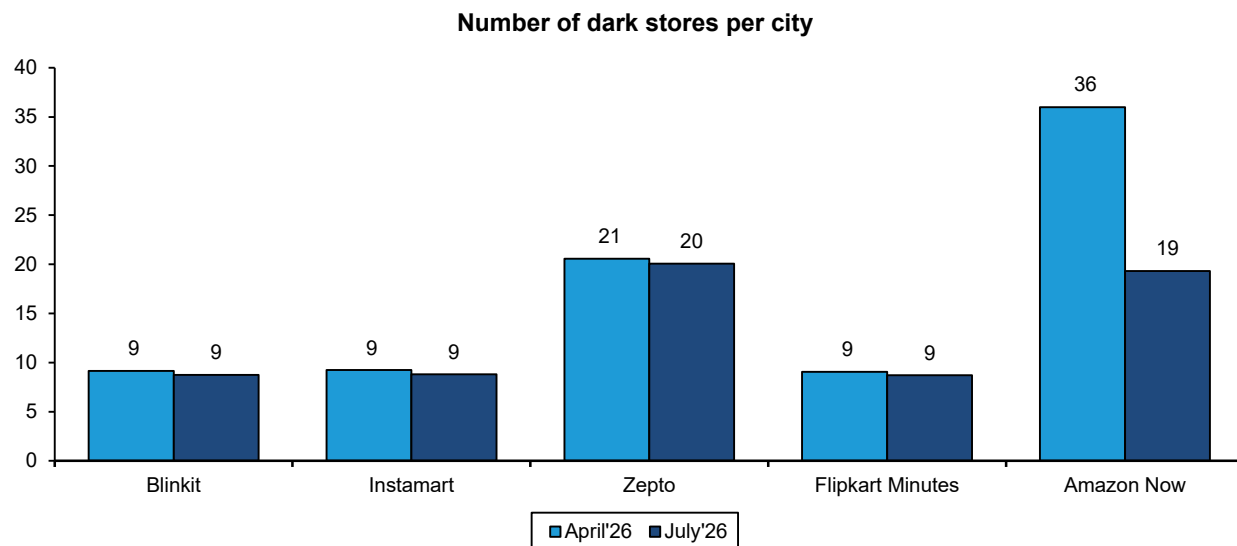
EXHIBIT 9: Unique serviceable pincodes rose by only ~150 in the quarter to 2,722 - new stores are largely going into already serviced areas

Our organized retail database estimates total coverage of ~4000 pincodes indicating that QC is already covering ~68% of all organized retail locations

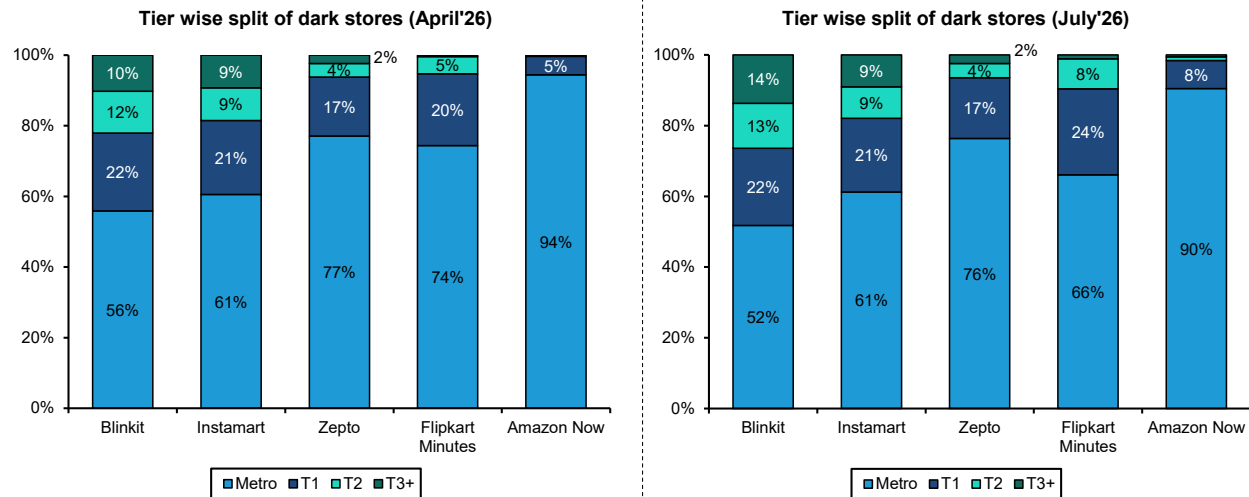


Source: Company, Bernstein store database & analysis

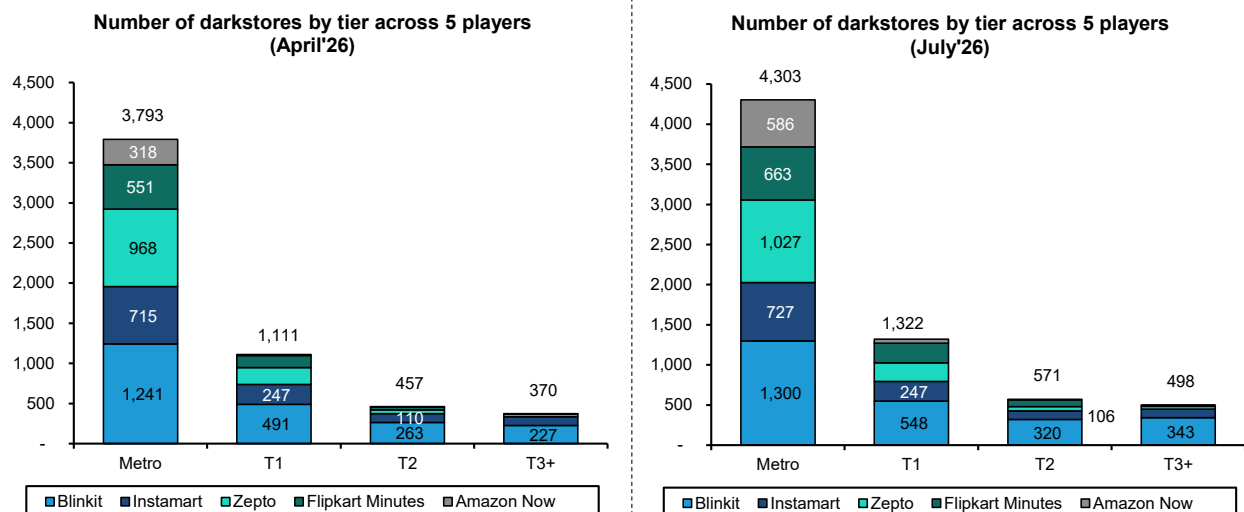
EXHIBIT 10: Amazon Now has expanded its city coverage, while the others are largely consistent



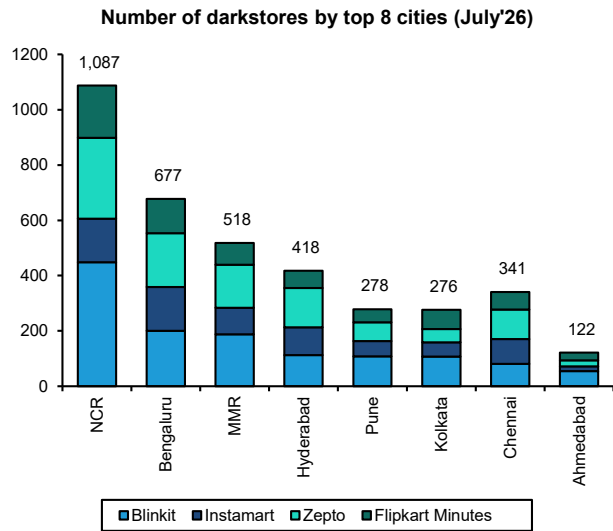
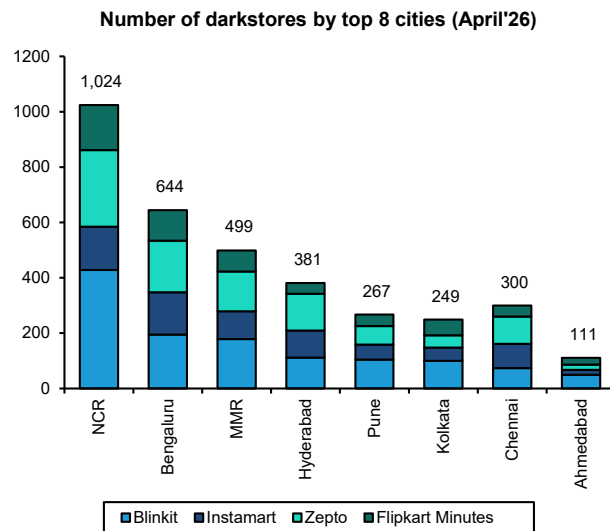
Source: Company, Bernstein store database & analysis

EXHIBIT 11: **Across the board, share of stores in Metro cities has nearly stayed constant**

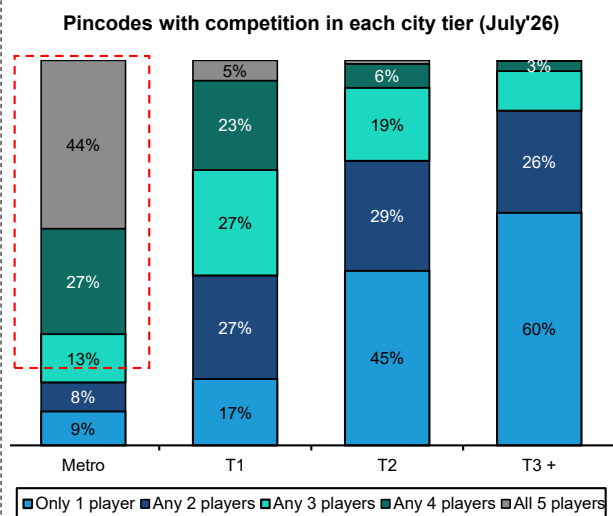
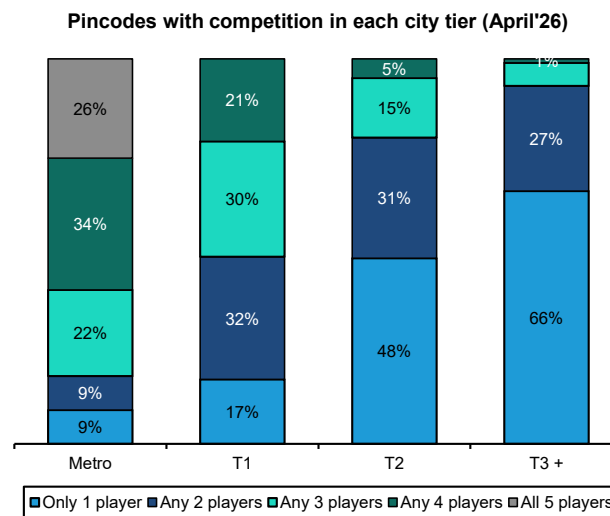
Source: Company, Bernstein store database & analysis

EXHIBIT 12: **Metro cities now have ~4300 dark stores against our estimated profitable store potential of ~3,600**

Source: Company, Bernstein store database & analysis

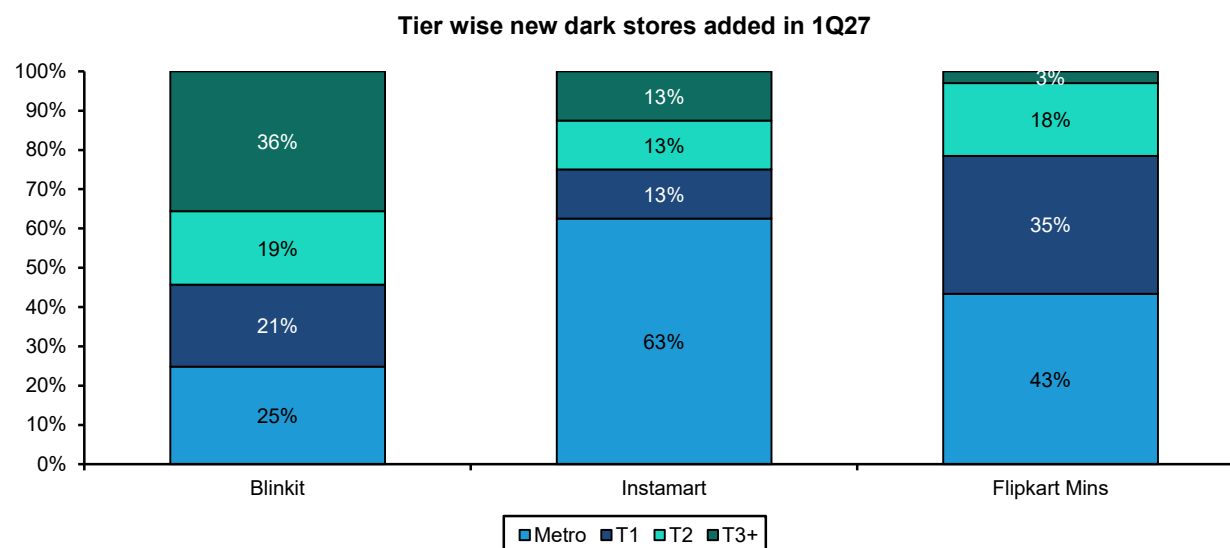
EXHIBIT 13: **Every Top-8 city added stores in the quarter.**

Source: Company, Bernstein store database & analysis

EXHIBIT 14: **Share of Metro pincodes served by all 5 players jumped from 26% to 44% in three months**

Source: Company, Bernstein store database & analysis

EXHIBIT 15: 75% of Blinkit's new stores in 1Q27 were outside Metros while Instamart added 63% of its new stores in Metros



Source: Company, Bernstein store database & analysis

SAME CITY. SAME CUSTOMER. SAME SKUS. SLIGHTLY DIFFERENT PLAYBOOKS

The line between e-commerce and quick commerce is blurring fast. Blinkit in their last earnings call mentioned that it now sells 80k+ SKUs in NCR and 50k+ in the next-7 metros while Instamart and Zepto also offer ~50k SKUs. When we fetched the assortment data from company websites in February 2026, Instamart offered ~44k SKUs and Blinkit ~35k in Bangalore with Flipkart Minutes at just ~10K ([Exhibit 16](#)). The assortment expansion in just a few months has been rapid. The non-grocery push is not accidental. As we detailed in our note on assortment ([link](#)), QC is a retail business with high variable cost and a cost floor of ~INR 95-100. Grocery alone cannot cover this cost as average order value is low. Non-grocery items carry higher prices and higher margins which means better AOVs and better take-rates for the platform. Non-grocery items already make up ~65% of listed SKUs across platforms ([Exhibit 17](#)) but only ~30% of NOV. The largest categories in the non-grocery segment are Home & Kitchen, Beauty & Personal care and Fashion ([Exhibit 18](#)).

QC players have clearly encroached on e-commerce territory and a part of future QC NOV growth could simply be a channel shift from e-commerce to quick commerce. We believe this positioning with customers is what has pushed Flipkart and Amazon to amp up their own QC efforts. The result is that product is no longer a differentiator. Every player now has SKUs across all major subcategories ([Exhibit 19](#)) and a customer, especially in a metro pincode sees similar products no matter which app the person opens ([Exhibit 20](#)). With similar products on offer the focus has shifted to creating new consumption occasions. QC apps see clear DAU spikes around occasion days like Valentine's Day, Rakhi, Diwali and New Year ([Exhibit 21](#)). Occasion days bring higher order frequency and a higher share of customer's wallet.

Pricing is where the strategies begin to diverge. Our discounting tracker of 30 national brand SKUs shows overall discounts still running at ~20-25%. Zepto, Amazon and Flipkart continue to deep-discount to acquire customers while Blinkit and Instamart are striving for better economics ([Exhibit 22](#)).

Dark stores are where the strategies differ most. A wider non-grocery assortment is a different warehousing problem as these SKUs are seasonal and slower moving with longer inventory cycles. Blinkit's answer is to split its assortment across multiple nearby stores serving the same pincode with some stores focused on grocery and others carrying the non-grocery and long-tail range ([Exhibit 23](#)). Instamart's answer is to consolidate everything into fewer and larger stores ([Exhibit 24](#)). The first approach keeps individual stores lean but adds routing complexity while the second comes with a higher cost structure. Amazon and Flipkart may go wide with fewer stores per city while Zepto stays dense. It is too early to declare a winner as these operators are optimizing for different combinations of market share, capital efficiency and profitability.

EXHIBIT 16: Instamart offers the highest SKU range (in a particular pincode) per our database with Blinkit close behind; Flipkart Minutes still appears to be ramping up its range

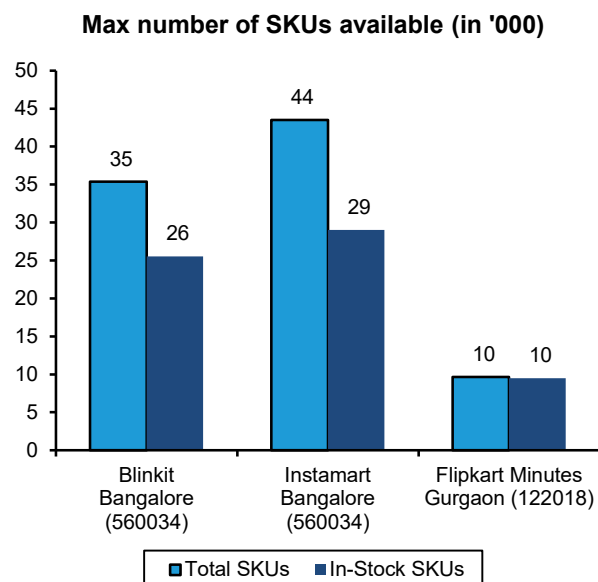
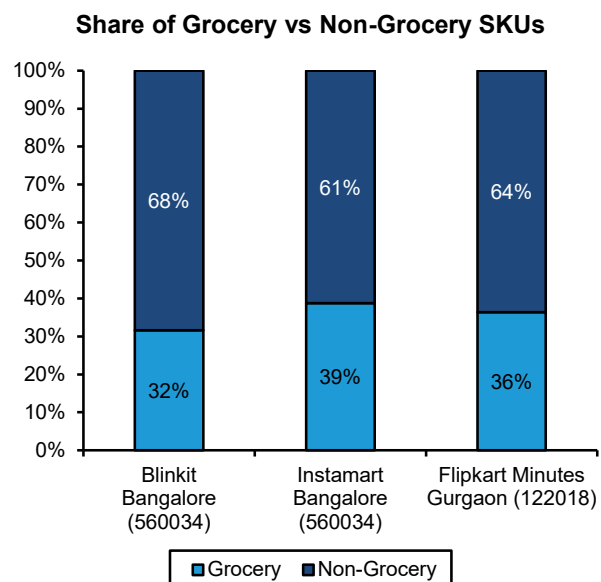


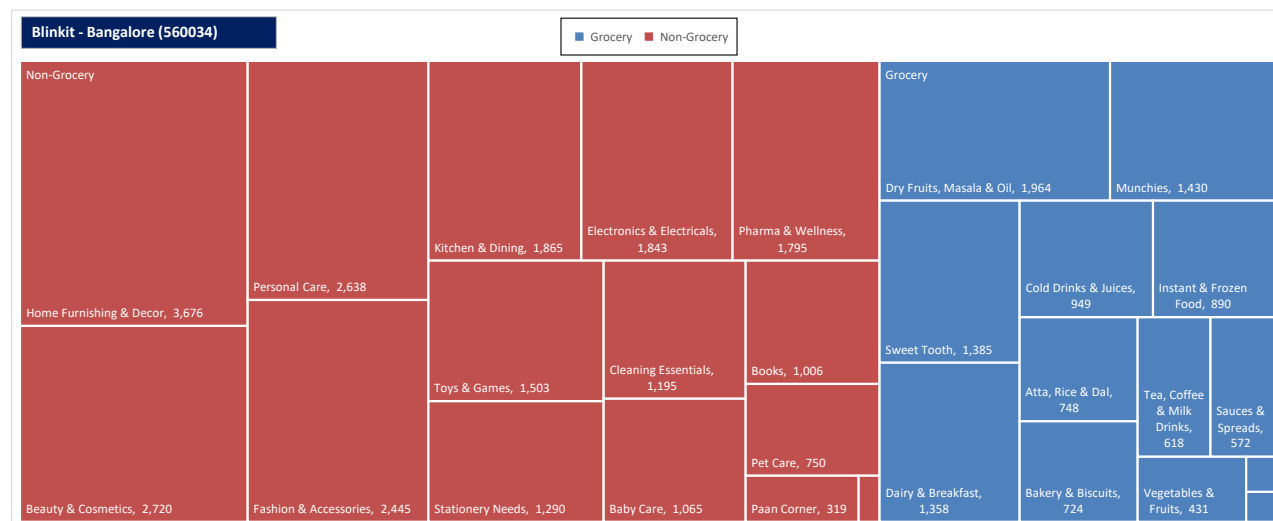
EXHIBIT 17: Non-grocery SKUs represent ~65% of SKUs available across platforms, even Flipkart which has a smaller SKU assortment



Source: Company websites, Bernstein analysis

Source: Company websites, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 18: Blinkit: Home & Kitchen, BPC and Fashion are largest non-grocery categories; Staples, Snacks and Desserts are largest grocery categories



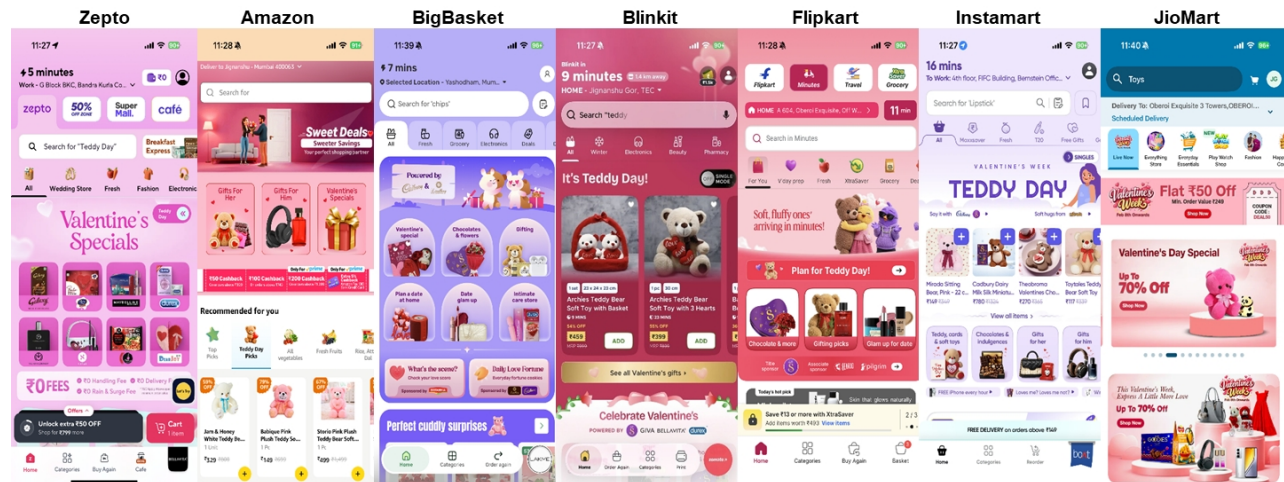
Source: Company websites, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 19: **All players have SKUs available across all major subcategories as well**

Category	Subcategory	Blinkit	Instamart	Zepto	Flipkart	Amazon	BigBasket
Fresh Items	Fresh Vegetables	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Fresh Fruits	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Dairy, Bread & Eggs	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Meat and Seafood	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Grocery & Kitchen	Atta, Rice & Dal	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Masalas	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Oils and Ghee	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Cereals and Breakfast	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Snacks & Drinks	Cold Drinks and Juices	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Ice Creams and Frozen Desserts	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Chips & Namkeen	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Chocolates	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Biscuits and Cakes	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Tea, Coffee & Milk Drinks	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Sauces & Spreads	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Sweet Corner	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Noodles, Pasta, Vermicelli	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Frozen Food	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Dry Fruits and Seeds Mix	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Paan Corner	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Beauty & Wellness	Bath & Body	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Hair	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Skin & Face	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Makeup	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Feminine Hygiene	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Baby Care	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Health & Pharma	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Sexual Wellness	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Protein & Nutrition	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Household & Lifestyle	Home and Kitchen	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Cleaners & Repellents	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Puja Store	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Toys & Stationery	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Electronics and Appliances	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Fashion	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Pet Supplies	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Sports & Fitness	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	School Supplies	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Hardware & Electricals	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

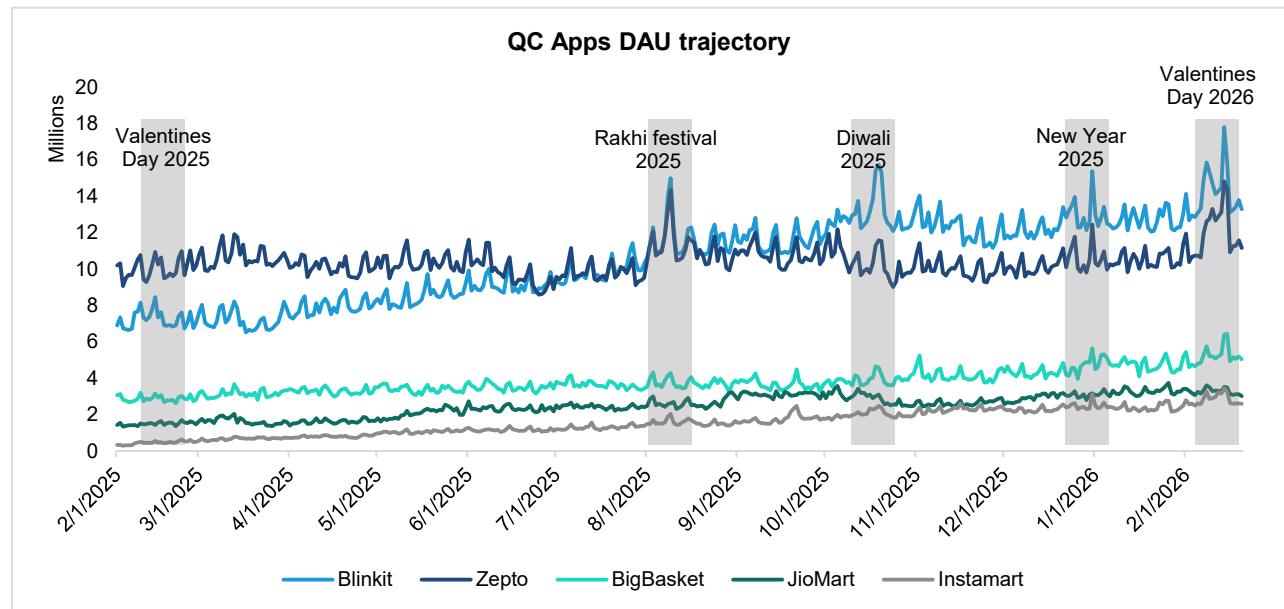
Source: Company websites, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 20: Quick Commerce Apps: Teddy Day (10th Feb 2026) within the Valentine's Week



Source: Company apps, Bernstein analysis

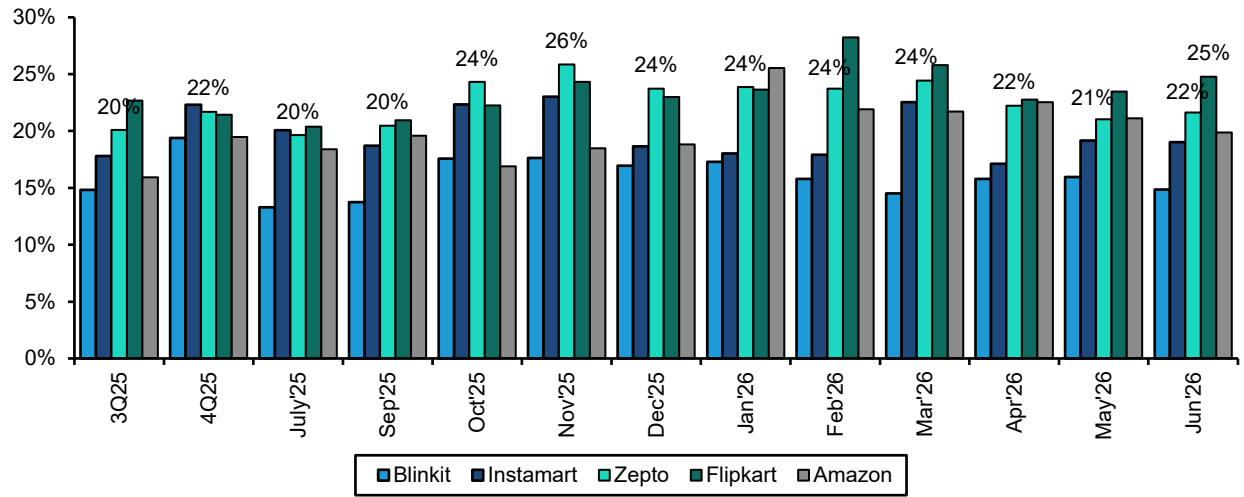
EXHIBIT 21: QC apps DAU also shows increased peaky nature of demand around occasion-days



Source: SensorTower, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 22: **Zepto, Amazon and Flipkart continue to deep-discount to acquire customers while Blinkit and Instamart are striving for better economics**

Overall discount on our basket of 30 national brand SKUs



Source: Channel Checks, Company, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 23: **Blinkit spreads its assortment across multiple dark stores per pincode**

Blinkit - (Number of SKUs, in '000)				
City (Pincode)	Darkstore	Grocery	Non-Grocery	Total
Gurgaon (122018)	D1	9.3	8.7	35
	D2	1.7	14.6	
	D3	0.0	0.1	
	D4	0.0	0.5	
	D5	0.0	0.0	
Bangalore (560034)	D1	9.4	0.0	35
	D2	1.5	0.0	
	D3	0.2	9.1	
	D4	0.1	14.5	
	D5	0.0	0.5	
Mumbai (400051)	D1	8.7	10.4	19
Mumbai (400034)	D1	8.4	10.7	20
	D2	0.0	0.5	
Chennai (600116)	D1	7.1	10.8	18
	D2	0.0	0.1	
Lucknow (226001)	D1	6.7	9.3	28
	D2	0.6	11.8	
Coimbatore (641002)	D1	5.7	15.1	21
Nashik (422006)	D1	8.3	17.5	26
Allahabad (211003)	D1	5.7	8.2	23
	D2	0.4	9.0	
Vallabh_vidya (388121)	D1	6.9	8.6	29
	D2	0.9	12.5	
	D3	0.0	0.1	
Thanesar (136118)	D1	7.9	20.9	29

Source: Company website, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 24: **Instamart consolidates assortment into fewer, larger dark stores per pincode**

Instamart - Number of SKUs, in '000)				
City (Pincode)	Darkstore	Grocery	Non-Grocery	Total
Gurgaon (122018)	D1	8.4	7.7	20
	D2	1.0	3.2	
Bangalore (560034)	D1	16.9	26.6	44
Mumbai (400051)	D1	8.8	9.7	26
	D2	5.2	2.5	
Mumbai (400034)	D1	15.6	20.5	36
Chennai (600116)	D1	7.6	6.0	26
	D2	2.8	9.1	
Lucknow (226001)	D1	5.4	4.6	10
Coimbatore (641002)	D1	7.9	7.5	20
	D2	0.7	4.0	
Nashik (422006)	D1	9.6	14.1	24
Allahabad (211003)	D1	6.8	9.6	16
Vallabh Vidyanagar (388121)	D1	6.5	5.2	18
	D2	1.1	5.0	
Thanesar (136118)	D1	8.0	11.5	19

Source: Company website, Bernstein analysis

TOUGH UNIT ECONOMICS ALREADY FORCING MODERATION OF CUSTOMER INCENTIVES.

QC direct costs have a floor of near INR 95-100 per order. Most of the cost of fulfilling an order sits in delivery, packaging and store operations which are variable or semi-variable in nature and cannot be compressed beyond a point. This puts a cap on the scope for operating leverage and means that improving unit economics has to come from better order monetization rather than from cost cuts alone.

The 4Q26 unit economics of the top 3 QC players show how far apart they are on the journey to profitability. Blinkit earns an adjusted revenue of INR 141 per order against a total cost of INR 140 which leaves it at break-even with an adjusted EBITDA of INR +1 per order ([Exhibit 25](#)). Instamart earns INR 97 per order against costs of INR 173 which leaves an EBITDA loss of INR 76 per order ([Exhibit 26](#)). Zepto sits in between with a loss of INR 59 per order as its low price positioning keeps its Net-AOV at ~INR 357 per order vs INR 500+ for the listed peers ([Exhibit 27](#)). We estimate the industry is losing ~\$2.5 Bn on an annualized run-rate basis. At this burn a strong balance sheet is a necessary but not sufficient condition of success.

We can observe some monetization efforts across the board - and the App home pages are instructive use cases of how to read the company's priorities.

- Blinkit's app home page focuses on products and categories - as well as the frequently bought links. There are no banners for low MOV or cash backs or deals or discounts. As a consumer, this reduces the clutter but also drives behavior of fast product access and transaction, sans distractions.
- Instamart's home page is incentivising the customer to increase AOVs. Only Rs 149 for free delivery but if you add Rs 50 more, the customer gets a Rs 1 product. This Rs 1 product is typically fresh F&V or a private label product or a promoted D2C brand - thus limiting the cost, while driving margins via AOV upgrade.
- Zepto seems to have increased its MOV (Minimum Order Value) for free delivery to Rs 149 and has also experimented with higher MOVs during rainy conditions in Mumbai.
- Amazon Now is clearly about aggressive customer acquisition. Their page has more offers than products - displaying zero platform fees, free delivery at Rs 99 and attractive cash back offers. Even the product display carousel is about discounted SKUs. However, we are seeing a sliding scale on cash backs - Rs 50 cash back is on AOV of Rs 399 for first 5 orders on Amazon

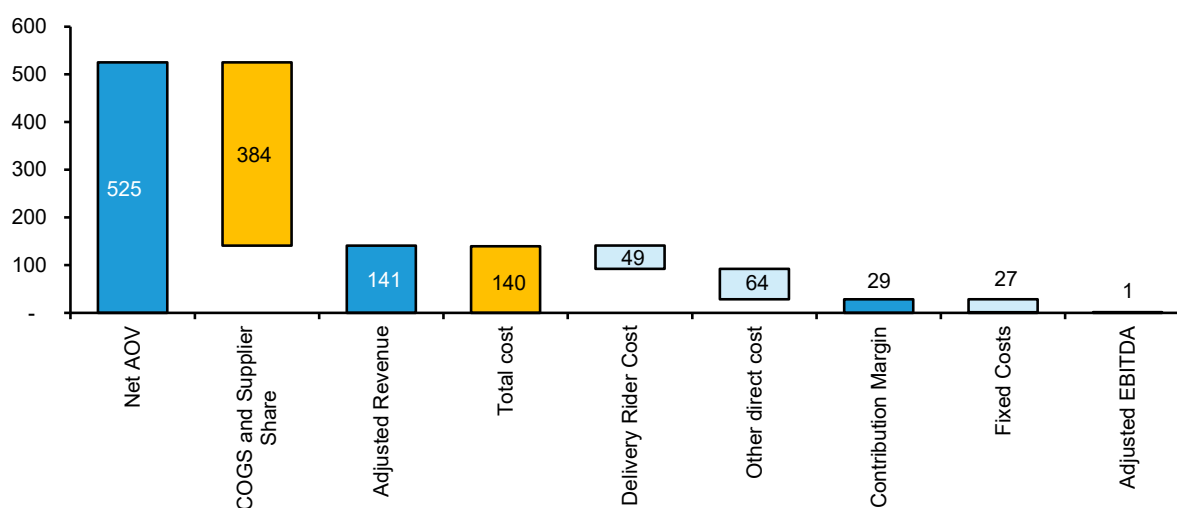
Now but the threshold increases to Rs 499 after that. This sliding scale is a mechanism to test the customer stickiness after having experience of delivering 5 orders.

- Flipkart's App is quite similar to that of Amazon - focusing exclusively on discounts and offers and deals. There is not a single product displayed.

We expect the discounting/ incentives led intensity to moderate in 2H26. We were expecting this to happen only in 2027, however as most QC players cross a milestone of ~1,000+ dark stores, we think they have sufficient scale to start thinking of unit economics. Any such moderation in incentives would likely benefit the market leaders with positive contribution margin profiles the most as every rupee of lower incentives flows through their bottom line while loss-making players still have a gap to close before incentives even matter.

EXHIBIT 25: **Blinkit - Unit Economics**

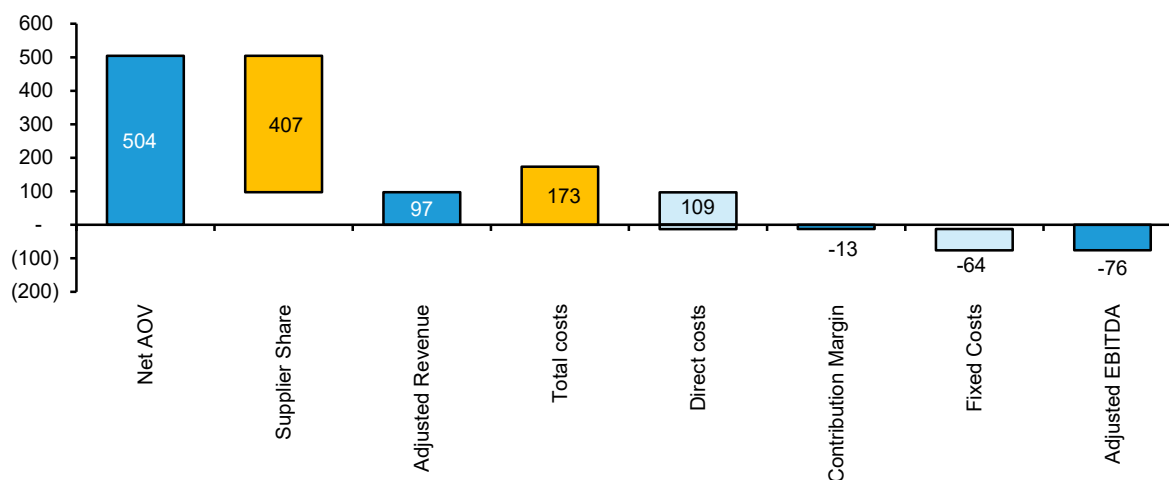
Blinkit - Quick Commerce - 4Q26 Unit Economics Breakup (INR Per Order)



Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 26: **Instamart - Unit Economics**

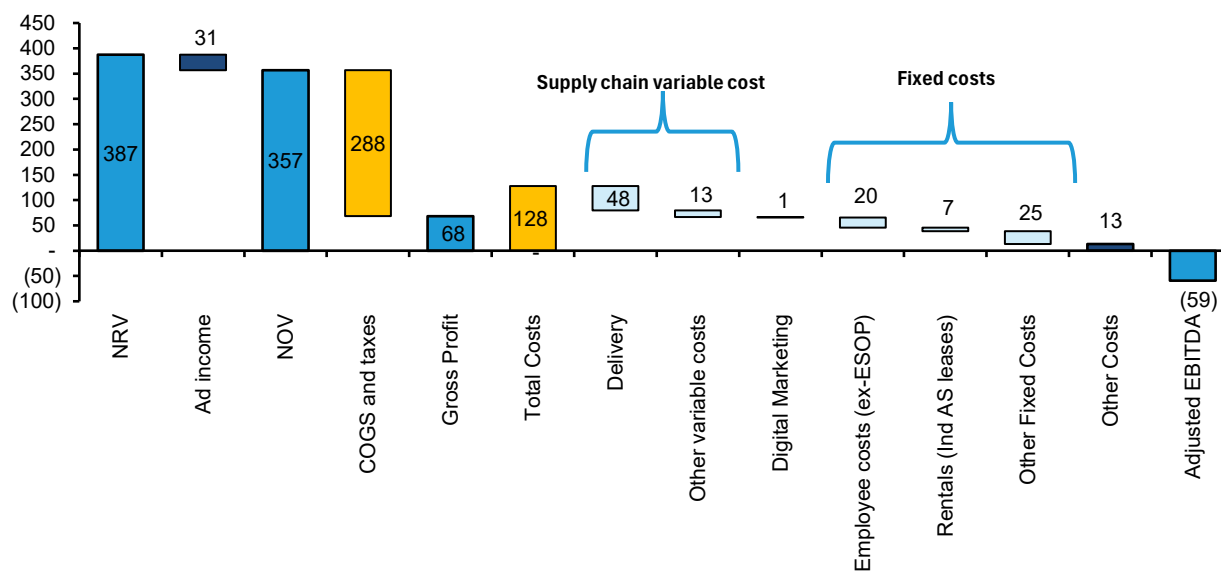
Instamart - Quick Commerce - 4Q26 Unit Economics Breakup (INR Per Order)



Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis

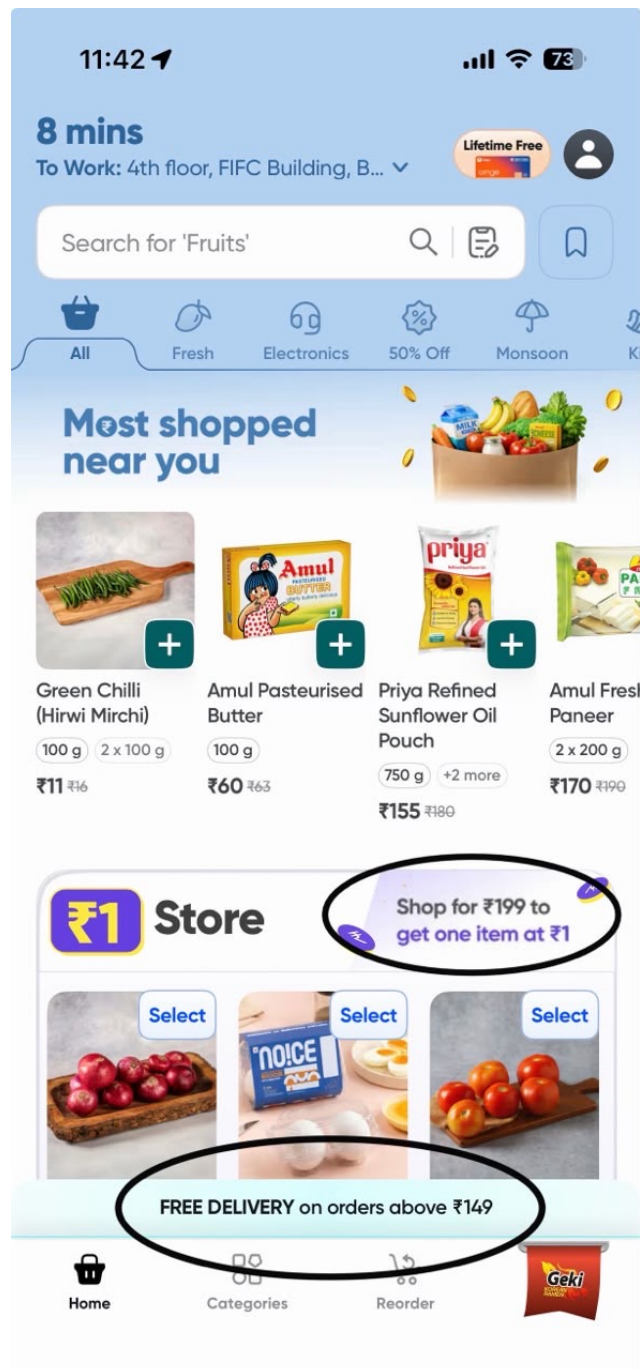
EXHIBIT 27: **Zepto - Unit Economics**

Zepto - 4Q26 Unit Economics Breakup (INR per order)



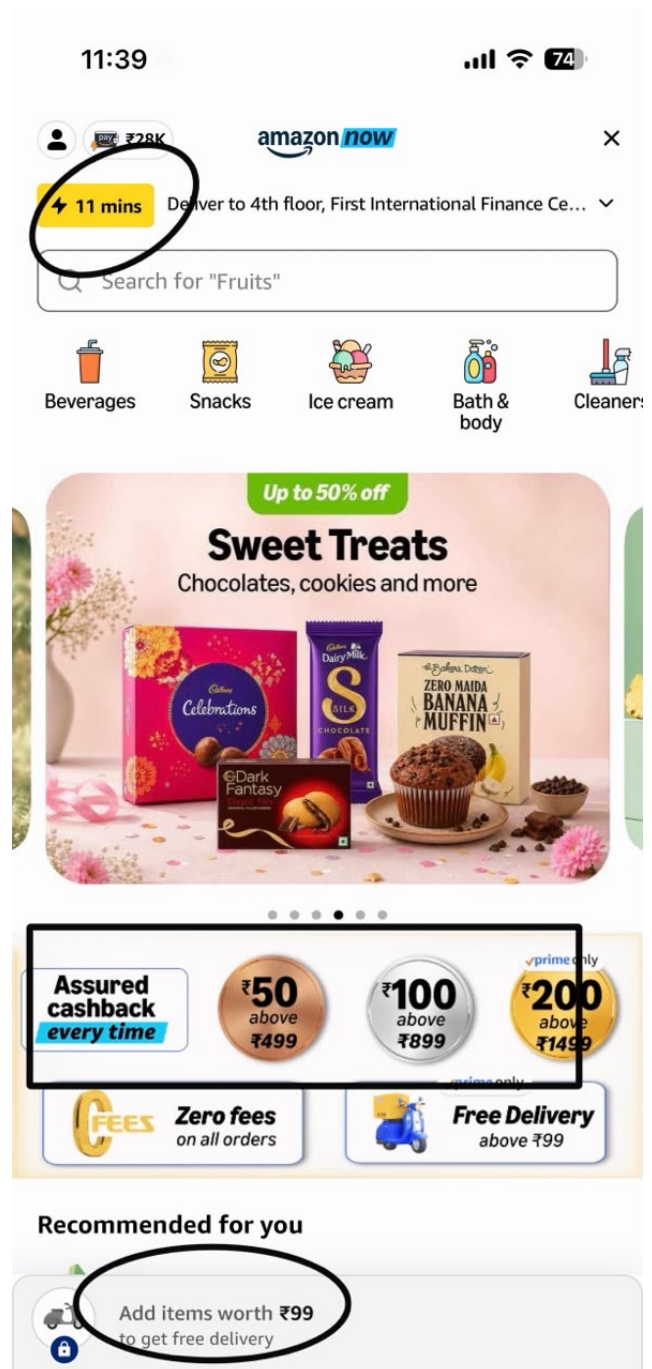
Source: Zepto DRHP, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 28: Screenshot from Instamart app



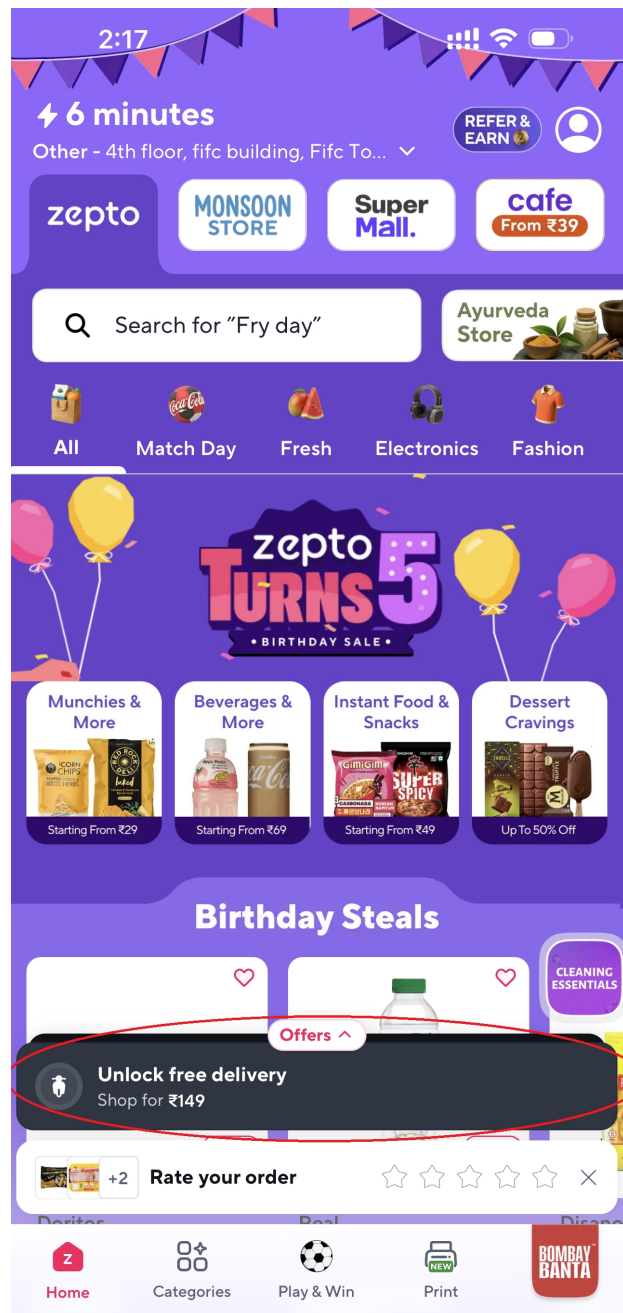
Source: Company apps, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 29: Screenshot from Amazon Now app



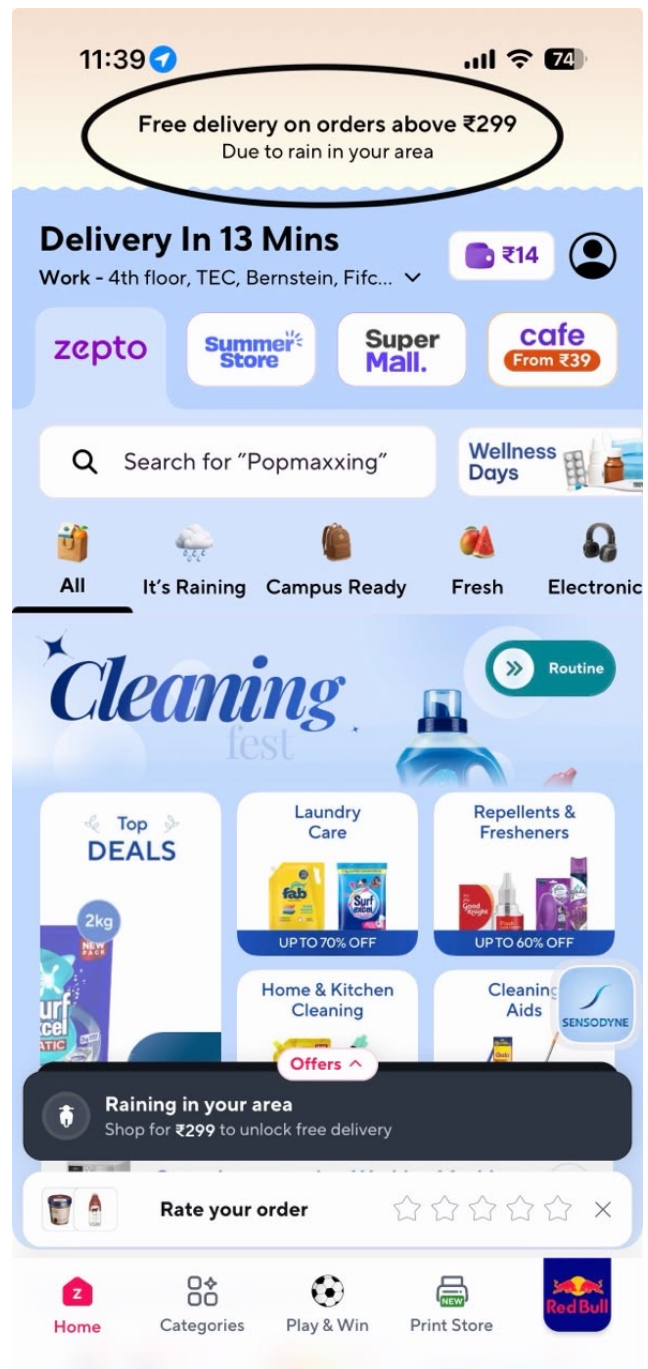
Source: Company apps, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 30: Screenshot from Zepto app



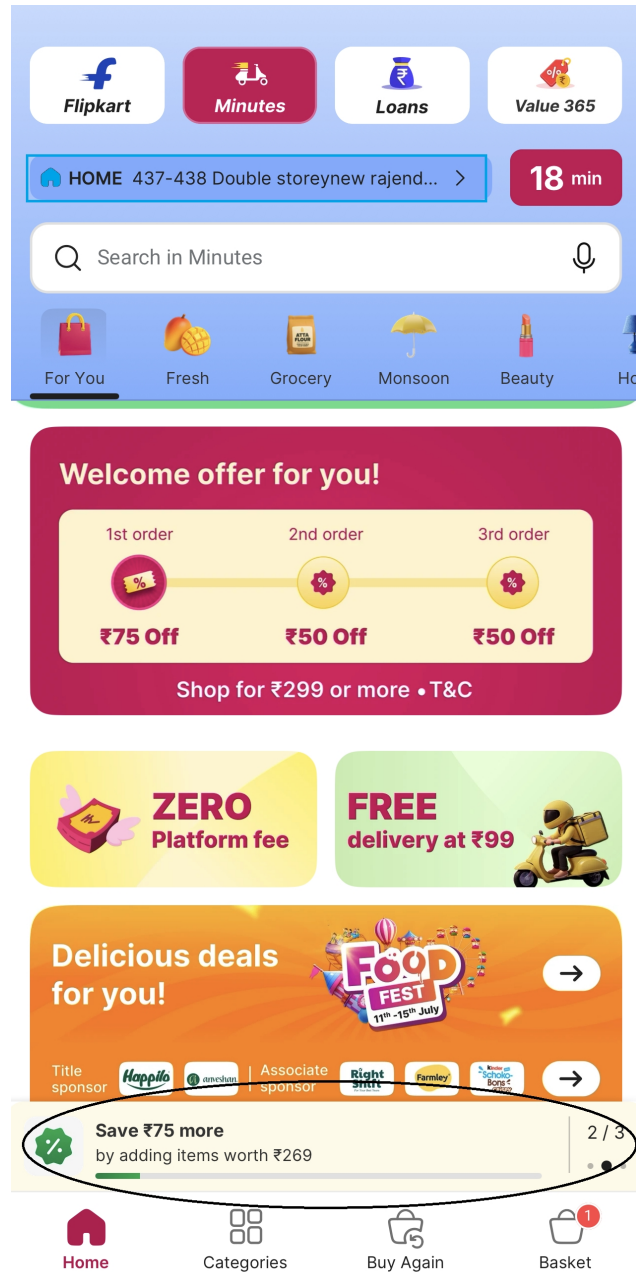
Source: Company apps, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 31: Screenshot from Zepto app



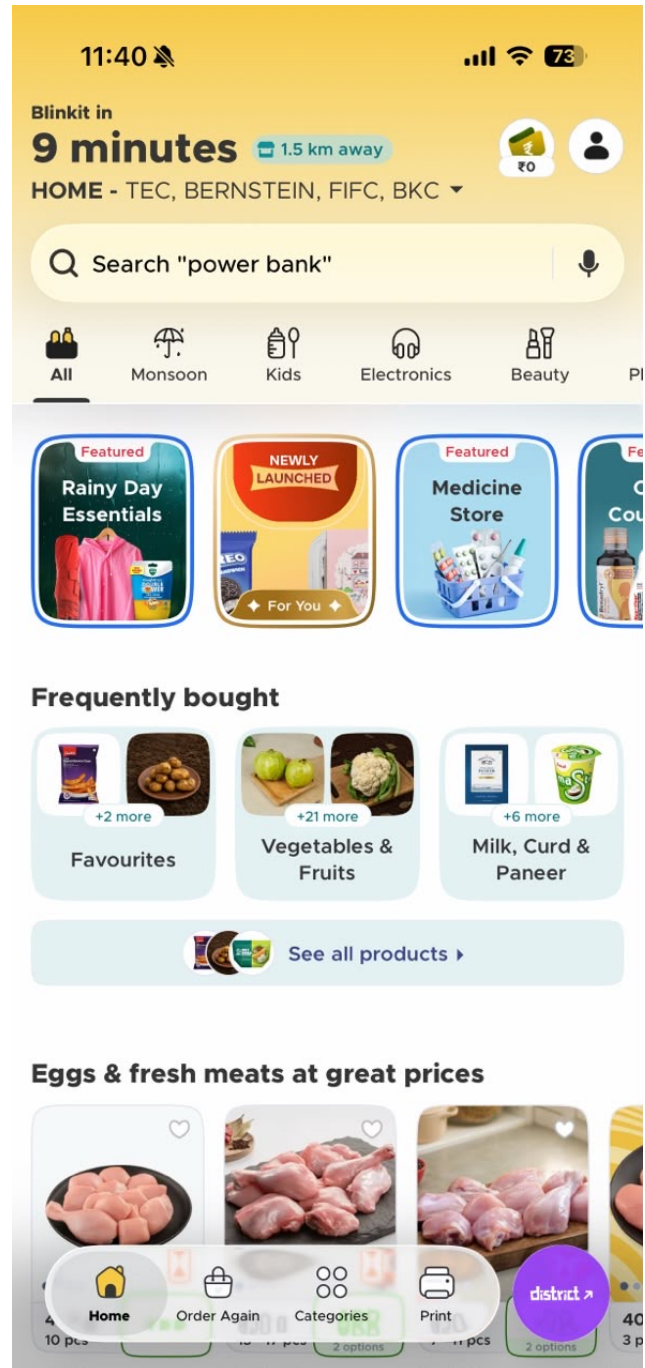
Source: Company apps, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 32: Screenshot from Flipkart Minutes app



Source: Company apps, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 33: Screenshot from Blinkit app



Source: Company apps, Bernstein analysis

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Eternal Limited**

We value Eternal using a multiple-based SOTP applying a 35x FY29 Adj. EBITDA for their food delivery business, a 30x FY30 Adj. EBITDA for Quick commerce (Blinkit), a 1.5x FY29 NOV for Going Out and a 1.0x FY29 Sales for Hyperpure business, resulting in a target price of INR 350 per share.

Swiggy Limited

We value Swiggy using a multiple-based SOTP applying a 35x FY29 Adj. EBITDA for their food delivery business, a 25x FY30 Adj. EBITDA to Quick commerce (Instamart), a 0.5x FY29 GOV for Out of home consumption and a 0.5x FY29 Sales for supply chain and distribution business, resulting in a target price of INR 430 per share.

RISKS**Eternal Limited**

Downside risks:

1. Regulatory risks like GST on delivery charges, anticompetitive charges in food delivery, etc.
2. Faster and better than expected ramp up by competition in quick-commerce
3. Structural or seasonal disruptions in the delivery rider ecosystem

Swiggy Limited

Downside risks:

1. Regulatory risks like GST on delivery charges, anticompetitive charges in food delivery, etc.
2. Faster and better than expected ramp up by competition in quick-commerce
3. Structural or seasonal disruptions in the delivery rider ecosystem

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- Underperform (UP): Stock will trail the performance of the relevant index by more than 10 pp

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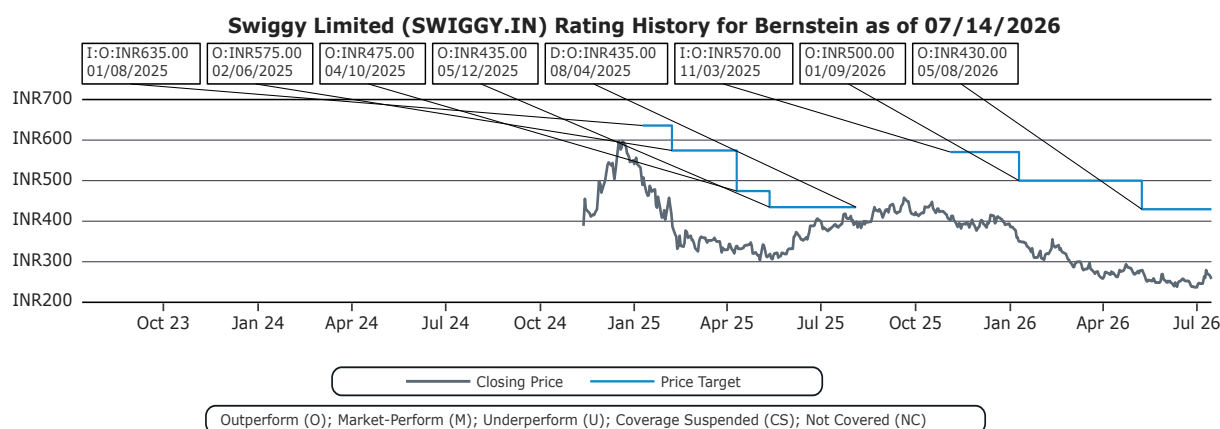
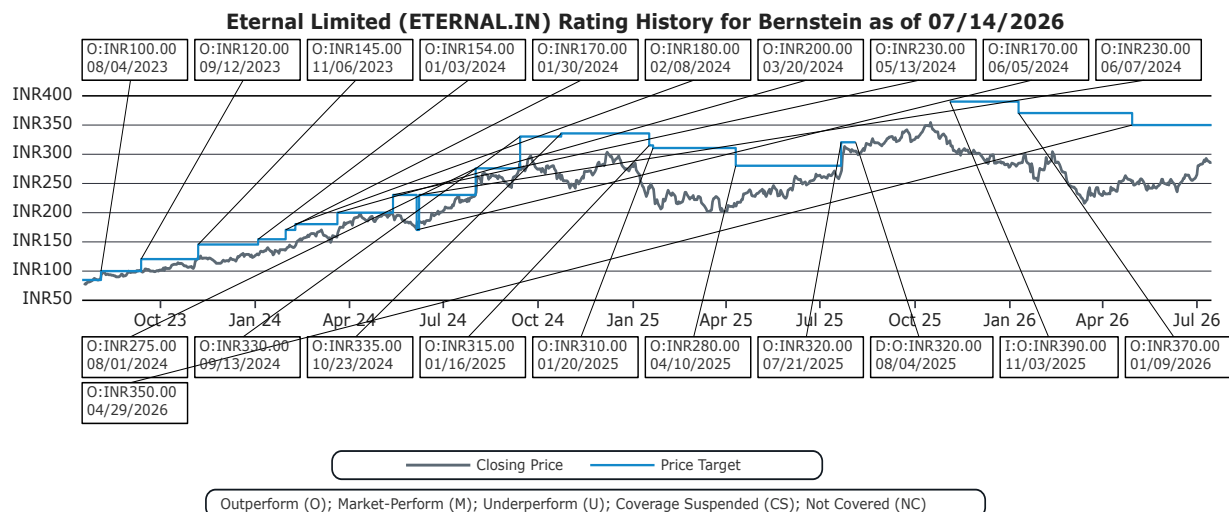
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Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

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